

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
 ♥ A K J
 ♦ J T 6 3 2
 ♣ A 9 7 2

♠ A K 7 5 4

♥ T 8 5

♦ A K

♣ 8 5 4



♠ T

♥ 9 6 4 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ K Q T 6 3

♠ Q J 9 8 6 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ Q 8 4

♣ J

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

it? Suit preference of course. Since it is a high spot card you are asking East to switch to the higher suit (choosing between ♦s and ♥s).

East dutifully plays a ♥ and you take the next three tricks. Had he switched to a ♦ instead, North would have been able to discard one of his ♥ losers on South's ♦Q.

[showcards W:CK]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣K, dummy's singleton was played

Play the ♣9.

East will look at your ♣9 and perhaps think for an instant that you want him to play another ♣.

But it will be a short instant because a look at dummy makes it absolutely clear to everybody that playing another ♣ could not help your side. Dummy has so many trumps that repeated ♣ leads would do nothing.

OK. If it's not an encouraging Attitude signal, what is

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
♥ 9 7 3
♦ A 8 7
♣ A K 9 8 6 4

♠ A T 6
♥ A K Q 4
♦ Q T 3
♣ Q J 2



♠ 8 3
♥ J T 6 2
♦ K J 9 5 4 2
♣ 3

♠ K Q J 9 7 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ 6
♣ T 7 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♠		3♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

[showcards W:CA S:C5 W:DA,CA]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.
Partner led the ♣A. Seeing your ♣3 he next played
the ♦A. What will you play on this trick?

Play the ♦2.

Normally with this holding you would play the ♦9 to
encourage West to play a second ♦ through
dummy's ♦Q 10.

But this time you really want him to take his ♣K. So
play the discouraging ♦2 and hope he gets the
message to go back to ♣s. If he does play the ♣K
next it will win and he can then give you a ♣ ruff.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J T 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ T 7 5

♣ A 9 5

♠ A K Q

♥ A T

♦ A J 4

♣ Q T 8 6 2



♠ 9 8 5

♥ K Q 8 5 3

♦ 9 6 2

♣ J 4

♠ 6 4 2

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ K 7 3

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

played the ♦6. He has an odd number of ♦s, obviously 3. And North must also have a third one, so he is up to some trickery with that ♣Q.

So grab your ♣A and return partner's ♥ suit.

[showcards S:HA,DA,DJ,CQ W:H5,D2,D6,C4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, you put on the ♥J, North won with the ♥A. The second trick was ♦A, ♦2, ♦3, ♦5. The third trick was ♦J, ♦6, ♦8, ♦7. North then put the ♣Q on the table.

Play the ♣A.

Does it look to you like North is trying to create an entry to dummy so he can cash the 2 ♦ winners?

That's what he wants it to look like, hoping someone holds up their ♣A.

But don't believe Declarer, believe your partner. On the first ♦ East played the ♦2. On the second ♦ he

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 5
♥ 9 7 4 2
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 7 6 5 2

♠ K 9 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ Q J 3

♣ A K 9



♠ T 3

♥ K Q 8 5

♦ 9 7 5 4

♣ Q 8 4

♠ A Q J 2

♥ J T 3

♦ A K T

♣ J T 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South

has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that South has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

[showcards W:S5]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. The 2♥ bid was a transfer. The 5NT bid meant to choose either 6♠ or 6NT. South liked the suit. Partner led the ♠5, won by South's ♠Q. South pulls one more trump with his ♠A, then wins three high ♦s. Next comes dummy's ♥A on which he plays the ♥3 and West plays the ♥9. Then he leads dummy's ♥6 which you win with the ♥Q. On this trick South drops the ♥J and West the ♥2. It is your play.

Play the ♥K.

If you believe South is now out of ♥s then you should not play your ♥K because it would give him a ruff-sluff.

But you shouldn't believe South when your partner has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that South has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

If you had not been paying attention to West's signal you might have decided to risk a ♣ lead - with a disastrous result.

Board 5

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 7 5 2

♥ T 5

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ Q 2

♠ K J 3

♥ K Q 7 6 4 3

♦ K T

♣ J 9



♠ A Q T

♥ 9 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ A K T 6 3

♠ 6 4

♥ A J 8

♦ A Q J 6

♣ 8 7 5 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	Pass
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

[showcards W:CA E:C2 S:C9]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♣A, West played the ♣2 and North the ♣9. What should you play to the second trick?

Play the ♣6.

On first thought West's ♣2 seems to be a discouraging signal. Think again.

After the first trick you know the location of every ♣ except the ♣Q and ♣J. If West started with ♣J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣J. If West started with ♣Q J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣Q. Since he did neither he started either with singleton ♣2 or with ♣Q 2. In either case you should play a low ♣ now which he will either win with his ♣Q or he will ruff.

It turns out that he wins with the ♣Q, then leads a ♠ back to your ♠ A Q.